Challenges Faced and Government's Agricultural Endeavors in Geographical Indications

While success stories abound, challenges persist. Farmers, particularly in remote regions, may face **difficulties in navigating the GI registration process**. Additionally, ensuring the **enforcement of GI rights** against unauthorized use remains a continuous challenge. Ensuring that **small-scale farmers**, who may lack resources and awareness, can easily access the GI registration process is crucial. In this regard, Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT), has undertaken a series of pioneering initiatives aimed at fostering inclusive growth and promoting indigenous products across the nation. One such transformative initiative is the **One District One Product (ODOP) scheme**, which aligns with the Prime Minister's vision to bolster balanced regional development. The scheme mandates the **selection, branding, and promotion** of a unique product from each district, catalyzing comprehensive socioeconomic advancement in every corner of the country. By recognizing and amplifying the distinctive characteristics of each district, the ODOP initiative not only stimulates local economic growth but also nurtures grassroots entrepreneurship.

Complementing the ODOP scheme are meticulously crafted **Product Action Reports**, developed in collaboration with the Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT). These reports delineate comprehensive action plans for Geographical Indication (GI) items, identifying bottlenecks in the supply chain and proposing strategic interventions to mitigate them. Incorporating Export-Import (EXIM) analysis and stakeholder feedback, these reports furnish a roadmap for various ministries, departments, and autonomous bodies to drive tangible progress. Moreover, the **One District One Product (ODOP)** scheme has facilitated **Buyer-Seller Meets (BSMs)** to bolster market linkages and enhance trade opportunities for GI goods. Concurrently, the initiative emphasizes the importance of training and upskilling artisans and producers, enabling them to modernize their craft while preserving its authenticity. Each program/ workshop under the **Skill Upgradation Program** or capacity development initiative accommodates a **batch of 20-40 authorized users** of GI-tagged products, spanning a period of **25 to 75 days**. In tandem with these efforts, DPIIT has launched several initiatives to heighten **awareness and capacity** in the domain of GIs.

Through **sensitization programs** and skill upgradation workshops, DPIIT aims to empower authorized users of GI-tagged products, fostering expertise and innovation. **Exhibitions, trade fairs,** and **Krishi Melas** serve as avenues to showcase GI products and facilitate networking opportunities. The events are organized for 5 to 15 days and accommodate a minimum of 25 stalls, with the number of stalls adjusted according to the organizer's capacity, approved by DPIIT, and allowing up to 2 authorized users per GI. Additionally, DPIIT extends **financial assistance** for **publicity campaigns, fashion shows,** and **international programs,** underscoring its commitment to bolstering the global presence of GI products. Furthermore, DPIIT provides support for GI studies and the establishment of GI Facilitation Centers, offering financial aid for research initiatives and operational expenses. Financial assistance for these programs ranges from INR 37.00 lakh per GI Facilitation Centre to a maximum of **INR 75 lakhs for international programs,** with specific amounts allocated for various activities such as exhibitions, skill upgradation, and GI awareness programs.



Government of India, steadfast in its commitment to promoting and safeguarding Geographical Indications (GIs) within the agricultural sector, has implemented transformative initiatives under the leadership of Hon'ble Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi and Shri Piyush Goyal, Hon'ble Union Minister of Commerce and Industry, Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution, Textiles. Through financial assistance, market facilitation, and awareness campaigns, the government has created a conducive environment for the flourishing of GI-tagged products both domestically and internationally. Looking ahead, the government remains committed to strengthening regulatory frameworks and fostering collaboration among stakeholders to ensure the sustained success and recognition of India's diverse GI-tagged agricultural offerings.